ment of the Jews in the post-1945 era is regarded as a profoundly negative development with global implications.

The embrace of this overarching idea, whether in the name of the "Palestinians," the "people," the "*umma*," or the "nation," has generated common, standardized rhetoric and behavior. To begin with, those who detest Jewish "communalism" usually detest the term "antisemitism" for the same reason, regarding it as a device to censor discussions of the Zionist present by invoking the sufferings of the Jewish past. "The word 'antisemitic,'" as Badiou, Hazan, and Segré insist, "is not only the most violent choice, but also the one with the least bearing on the present reality."[21]

Then there is the tendency to elevate the Palestinian cause—a local struggle not dissimilar from the myriad other national conflicts in the world today—into what might be called the ideology of "Palestinianism." From this vantage point, the Palestinians become iconic, transcendental victims, rather like the Jews were for a brief period after the Second World War. Those who kneel before the altar of Palestinian suffering with almost spiritual fervor can be relied on to traffic in the kinds of themes that have now gained a foothold in mainstream discourse: that Israel, the Jewish state, is a carbon copy of South Africa's old apartheid regime, that it consciously mimics the practices of the Nazis, that it is—as formulated in the perverse Twitter hashtag #JSIL—a Jewish reflection of the Islamic State terrorist gang that has raped, murdered, enslaved and decapitated thousands of innocents in Syria and Iraq.

Because we are dealing with a social movement, there are no restrictions of education, or ethnicity (appropriately anti-Zionist Jews can participate, thereby assisting the wider movement in deflecting charges of antisemitism) or social class, or political affiliation, when it comes to getting involved. Similarly, there are no requirements to pay membership dues, or sell publications, or any of the drab imperatives that characterized earlier generations of political activism. Instead, the emphasis is on spectacle.Supporters of the Boycott, Divestment, and Sanctions (BDS) movement are increasingly prone to raiding supermarkets and forcibly removing Israeli goods from the shelves, filming themselves as they do so and displaying the results on blogs, websites and other social media platforms. Young people, especially, can make a statement by photographing themselves performing the "quenelle," the inverted Nazi salute popularized by Dieudonné, and posting the image online; as Dave Rich observed in an article about the quenelle phenomenon, "this may be the first individualist mass movement of the social media age."[22] Through such practices, slowly but surely, what was once taboo becomes normalized for large sections of the population.

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